

ZIZODIGITALSTUDIO



Christmas Gift Exchange Treats

10 festive recipes for cookies, candy & homemade food gifts

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A Little Holiday Joy, Made to Share

These ten festive recipes were chosen for easy gifting, beautiful presentation, and dependable results. You will find crisp cookies, chocolate treats, cozy drink mix, candied nuts, and one savory cracker - something for every Christmas exchange.

GIFTING NOTES

Cool baked goods completely before packing. Use airtight containers, add a made-on date, and clearly label common allergens such as milk, wheat, eggs, and nuts.

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RECIPE 01

Cranberry Pistachio Biscotti

A jewel-toned, twice-baked cookie made for coffee lovers

Makes 22 biscotti

Prep 20 min | Bake 42 min

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups (250 g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup (150 g) granulated sugar
- 3 large eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 tsp finely grated orange zest
- 3/4 cup (90 g) shelled pistachios
- 2/3 cup (85 g) dried cranberries

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350 F (175 C). Line a baking sheet with parchment.
2. Whisk flour, baking powder, and salt. In a second bowl, whisk sugar, eggs, vanilla, and orange zest until smooth.
3. Stir dry ingredients into the egg mixture, then fold in pistachios and cranberries. Shape into two 10 x 2-inch logs.
4. Bake 24-26 minutes, until lightly golden. Cool 12 minutes, then slice diagonally into 1/2-inch pieces.
5. Lower oven to 325 F (165 C). Bake slices 8 minutes per side. Cool completely before packing.

GIFT IT

Stack in a clear bag or narrow box with parchment between layers. Best within 2 weeks.



RECIPE 02

Gingerbread Truffles

Soft spiced centers wrapped in a smooth chocolate shell

Makes 20 truffles

Prep 30 min | Chill 1 hr

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups (220 g) finely crushed ginger cookies
- 4 oz (115 g) cream cheese, softened
- 1 tbsp molasses
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/4 tsp ground ginger
- 8 oz (225 g) dark or milk chocolate, chopped
- 2 oz (55 g) white chocolate, optional
- 2 tbsp crushed ginger cookies, for garnish

METHOD

1. Mix cookie crumbs, cream cheese, molasses, cinnamon, and ginger until evenly combined.
2. Roll tablespoon portions into balls. Chill on a lined tray for 30 minutes.
3. Melt dark chocolate gently in short microwave bursts, stirring between each burst.
4. Dip each chilled ball in chocolate and return to the tray. Add cookie crumbs or white-chocolate drizzle.
5. Chill until firm, then store refrigerated in an airtight container.

GIFT IT

Place in mini paper cups inside a rigid gift box. Keep chilled and gift within 4 days.



RECIPE 03

Peppermint Chocolate Bark

Crisp dark chocolate with creamy swirls and candy-cane crunch

Makes about 1 lb

Prep 15 min | Chill 30 min

INGREDIENTS

- 12 oz (340 g) dark chocolate, chopped
- 6 oz (170 g) white chocolate, chopped
- 1/2 tsp peppermint extract
- 1/3 cup crushed peppermint candy
- Pinch of flaky salt, optional

METHOD

1. Line a rimmed baking sheet with parchment.
2. Melt dark chocolate gently and spread into a roughly 9 x 12-inch rectangle.
3. Melt white chocolate, stir in peppermint extract, and spoon over the dark layer.
4. Swirl lightly with a skewer. Sprinkle with crushed peppermint and flaky salt.
5. Chill until firm, then break into irregular pieces.

GIFT IT

Layer between parchment in a tin. Store cool and dry for up to 2 weeks.



RECIPE 04

Maple Cinnamon Candied Pecans

Glossy, fragrant nuts with a crisp caramelized coating

Makes 3 cups

Prep 10 min | Bake 28 min

INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups (300 g) pecan halves
- 1 large egg white
- 1 tbsp water
- 1/3 cup (70 g) brown sugar
- 2 tbsp pure maple syrup
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1/4 tsp nutmeg
- 1/2 tsp fine salt

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 300 F (150 C). Line a sheet pan with parchment.
2. Whisk egg white and water until foamy. Stir in brown sugar, maple syrup, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt.
3. Fold in pecans until evenly coated, then spread in one layer.
4. Bake 25-28 minutes, stirring twice, until dry and fragrant.
5. Cool completely before breaking apart and packing.

GIFT IT

Fill airtight jars and add an ingredient label for nut allergies. Best within 3 weeks.



RECIPE 05

Orange Cardamom Shortbread

Buttery slice-and-bake cookies with bright citrus and warm spice

Makes 28 cookies

Prep 20 min | Chill 1 hr | Bake 14 min

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (225 g) unsalted butter, softened
- 2/3 cup (80 g) powdered sugar
- 2 tsp finely grated orange zest
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 cups (250 g) all-purpose flour
- 1/2 tsp ground cardamom
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 2 tbsp coarse sugar, optional

METHOD

1. Beat butter and powdered sugar until smooth. Mix in orange zest and vanilla.
2. Add flour, cardamom, and salt; mix just until a dough forms.
3. Shape into a 2-inch-wide log, wrap, and chill for 1 hour.
4. Heat oven to 350 F (175 C). Slice dough 1/4 inch thick and arrange on lined sheets.
5. Sprinkle with coarse sugar and bake 12-14 minutes, until edges are pale gold. Cool fully.

GIFT IT

Pack in a metal tin with parchment. Flavor improves overnight; enjoy within 10 days.



RECIPE 06

Layered Hot Cocoa Mix Jars

A cozy make-at-home drink gift with chocolate and marshmallows

Makes 4 small jars

Prep 15 min

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (100 g) unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 cup (120 g) powdered milk
- 3/4 cup (90 g) powdered sugar
- 1/2 cup (85 g) mini chocolate chips
- 1 cup mini marshmallows
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 4 clean 12-oz jars

METHOD

1. Whisk cocoa, powdered milk, powdered sugar, and salt until uniform.
2. Divide the cocoa mixture evenly among the jars and gently level it.
3. Add an even layer of chocolate chips, then fill the tops with marshmallows.
4. Seal tightly. Attach serving directions: stir 1/3 cup mix into 1 cup hot water or milk.
5. Store in a cool, dry place away from direct sunlight.

GIFT IT

Include a small wooden spoon and a clear allergen note. Use within 2 months.



RECIPE 07

Pecan Snowball Cookies

Tender, nutty cookies covered in a snowy layer of sugar

Makes 30 cookies

Prep 20 min | Bake 14 min

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (225 g) unsalted butter, softened
- 1/2 cup (60 g) powdered sugar, plus more for coating
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 1/4 cups (280 g) all-purpose flour
- 1/4 tsp fine salt
- 3/4 cup (85 g) finely chopped toasted pecans

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350 F (175 C). Line two baking sheets.
2. Beat butter and powdered sugar until creamy; mix in vanilla.
3. Add flour and salt, then fold in pecans. Roll into 1-inch balls.
4. Bake 12-14 minutes, until bottoms are lightly golden.
5. Cool 5 minutes, roll gently in powdered sugar, then coat once more when completely cool.

GIFT IT

Use a shallow box so the coating stays neat. Label clearly because the cookies contain nuts.



RECIPE 08

Salted Caramel Pretzel Clusters

Crunchy, chewy, sweet-and-salty bites with chocolate drizzle

Makes 18 clusters

Prep 25 min | Set 30 min

INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups mini pretzels, lightly crushed
- 11 oz (310 g) soft caramels, unwrapped
- 2 tbsp heavy cream
- 1/2 cup (85 g) semisweet chocolate chips
- 1 tsp neutral oil
- 1/2 tsp flaky salt

METHOD

1. Line a tray with parchment and place 18 mini paper liners on it.
2. Melt caramels with cream over low heat, stirring until smooth.
3. Fold in pretzels and quickly spoon the mixture into the liners.
4. Melt chocolate with oil and drizzle over the clusters.
5. Sprinkle lightly with flaky salt and leave to set before packing.

GIFT IT

Keep each cluster in its paper liner and pack in a firm box. Best within 1 week.



RECIPE 09

Cranberry White Chocolate Oatmeal Cookies

Chewy oatmeal cookies filled with festive red and creamy white pieces

Makes 24 cookies

Prep 20 min | Bake 12 min

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (225 g) unsalted butter, softened
- 3/4 cup (150 g) brown sugar
- 1/3 cup (65 g) granulated sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 1/2 cups (190 g) all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 2 1/2 cups (225 g) rolled oats
- 3/4 cup dried cranberries
- 3/4 cup white chocolate chunks

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350 F (175 C). Line baking sheets with parchment.
2. Beat butter and both sugars until creamy. Beat in eggs and vanilla.
3. Mix flour, baking soda, and salt separately; stir into the wet ingredients.
4. Fold in oats, cranberries, and white chocolate. Scoop 2-tablespoon portions.
5. Bake 10-12 minutes, until edges are set. Cool on the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer.

GIFT IT

Stack in a basket or cookie box with parchment. Best enjoyed within 5 days.



RECIPE 10

Rosemary Parmesan Gift Crackers

A crisp savory option for cheese boards and holiday hosts

Makes about 48 crackers

Prep 25 min | Bake 16 min

INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups (190 g) all-purpose flour
- 3/4 cup (75 g) finely grated Parmesan
- 1 tbsp finely chopped rosemary
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 5 tbsp (70 g) cold unsalted butter, cubed
- 5-6 tbsp cold water
- 1 tbsp olive oil and extra Parmesan, for topping

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 375 F (190 C). Line two baking sheets.
2. Mix flour, Parmesan, rosemary, salt, and pepper. Cut in butter until crumbly.
3. Add cold water gradually until the dough holds together. Chill for 15 minutes.
4. Roll very thin between parchment sheets and cut into small squares.
5. Brush lightly with oil, sprinkle with Parmesan, and bake 14-16 minutes until crisp and golden.

GIFT IT

Cool completely before sealing in a jar. Pair with a note suggesting cheese or soup.

Thank You for Reading

We hope these festive recipes bring warmth, generosity, and a little extra joy to your Christmas celebrations.

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